Power & USB

File: power_usb.kicad_sch

ESP32

File: mcu.kicad_sch

H1
M3

H2
M3

H3
M3

H4
M3

HV supply

File: hv_supply.kicad_sch

Display

File: display.kicad_sch

electroNIX–USB: USB–C powered ESP32 nixie clock, 4 x Z573M

Electrical design follows TESTA–QUADRA electroNIXclock 3 (PCB–036, 2013),
the micro–USB powered board: 5 V boost + 7–diode multiplier to 170 V,
MMBTA42/MMBTA92 discrete tube drivers, neon colon, buzzer, light sensor.

Changes from PCB–036:
- ATmega16 replaced by ESP32–WROOM–32E with the firmware's electroNIX 3 GPIO map
- USB–C (5k1 sink) + polyfuse + TVS + USBLC6, CH340C for programming
- DS3231M + CR2032 instead of the 32 kHz crystal and supercap
- HV feedback clamp to 3V3, base resistors resized for 3.3 V drive
- buzzer moved IO0 –> IO12 (IO0 pull–down through the buzzer base forced download mode)
- two independent colon neons (SEC_0, SEC_1)

Licensed with the repository; see LICENSE

ESP32 rework of TESTA–QUADRA electroNIXclock 3 (PCB–036), USB powered

electroNIX–USB (Z573M)

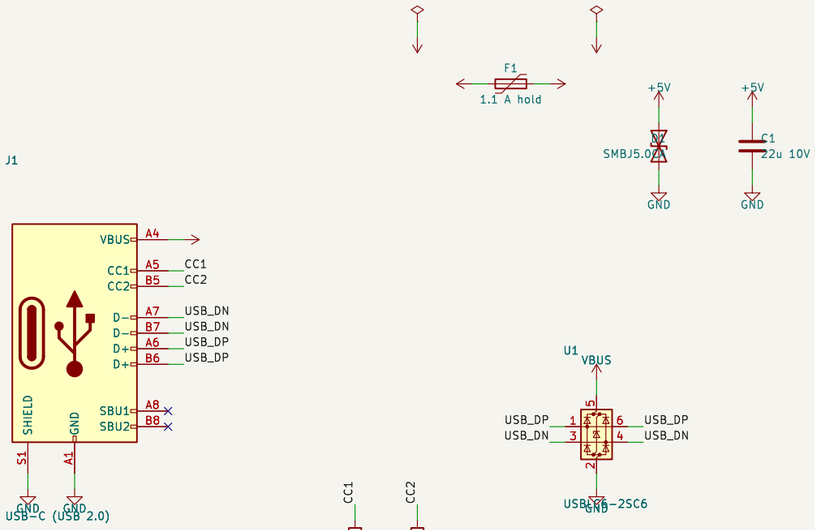
Sheet: /

File: electroNIX–USB.kicad_sch

Title: electroNIX–USB (Z573M) – overview

Size: A3	Date: 2026–10–15	**Rev: 0.1**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad–cli 7.0.11+dfsg–1build4		Id: 1/5

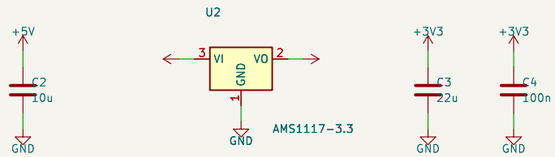
USB-C input (5 V only, sink: 5k1 on CC1/CC2)



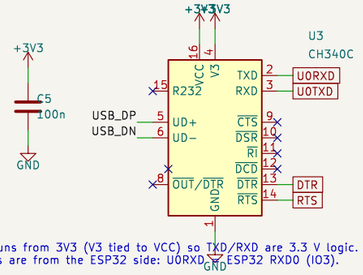


VBUS feeds the boost converter and the 3.3 V LDO only.
Budget from a 500 mA port: ESP32 ~250 mA avg (500 mA WiFi peaks),
HV supply ~150 mA at 4 tubes. A USB-C source gives 1.5–3 A at 5V.

3.3 V regulator



USB–UART (programming + serial log)



CH340C runs from 3V3 (V3 tied to VCC) so TXD/RXD are 3.3 V logic.
Net names are from the ESP32 side: U0RXD ← ESP32 RXD0 (IO3).

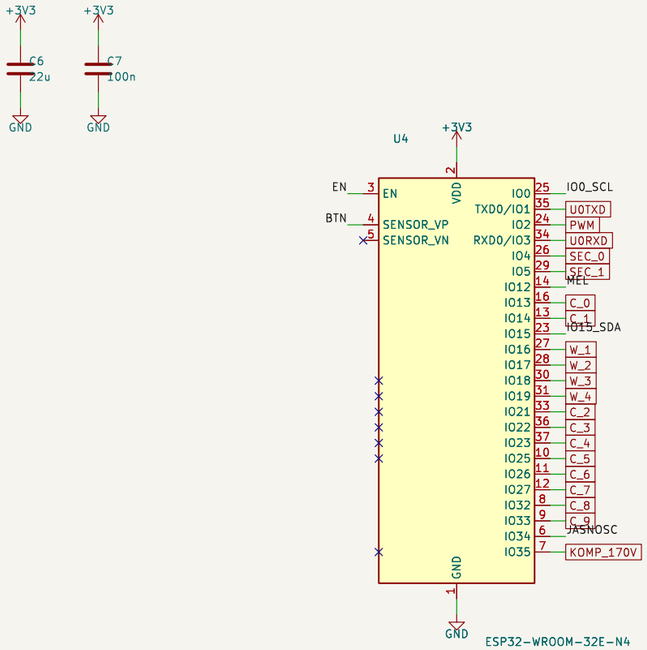
Licensed with the repository; see LICENSE
ESP32 rework of TESTA-QUADRA electroNIXclock 3 (PCB-036), USB powered
electroNIX-USB (Z573M)

Sheet: /Power & USB/
File: power_usb.kicad_sch

Title: electroNIX-USB – USB-C power, 3.3 V, USB-UART

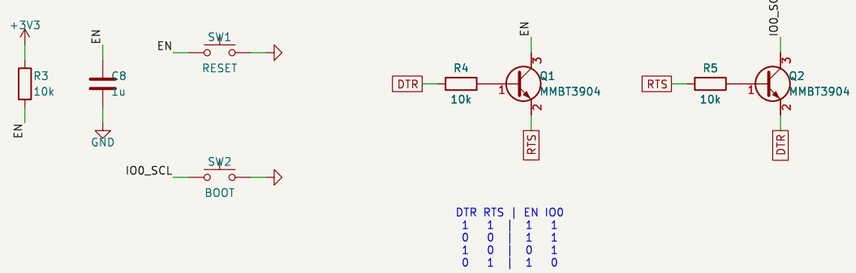
Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-15	**Rev: 0.1**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 2/5

ESP32 module (GPIO map = firmware BOARD_ELECTRONIX_3, except MEL/RTC)



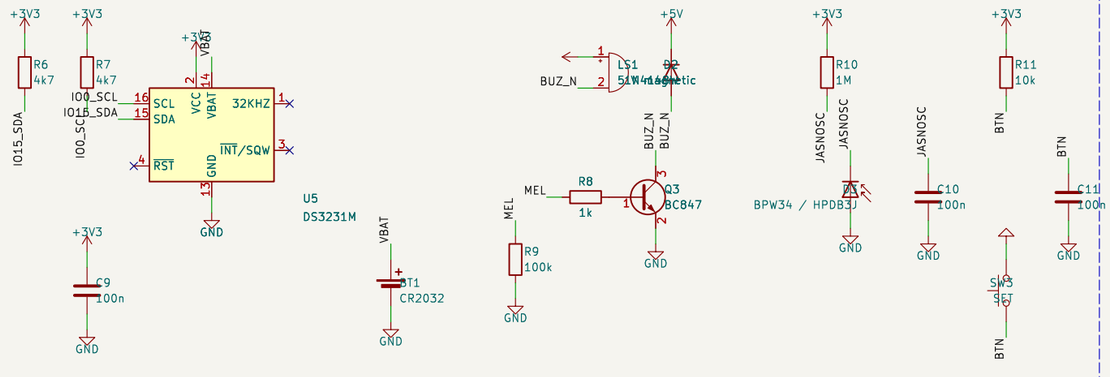
Strapping pins at reset:
IO0 high = run (4k7 SCL pull-up; BOOT / auto-reset pull it low)
IO2 low/float (boost gate pull-down on HV sheet)
IO12 low = 3.3 V flash (100k pull-down on MEL)
IO15 high (4k7 SDA pull-up)
IO5 SEC_1 neon driver base – default state is harmless

Reset, boot and auto-program (DTR/RTS)



DTR	RTS	EN	IO0
1	1	1	1
0	0	1	1
1	0	0	1
0	1	1	0

Peripherals



DS3231M: optional (DNP for NTP-only builds).
I2C on IO15 (SDA) / IO0 (SCL).

Licensed with the repository; see LICENSE

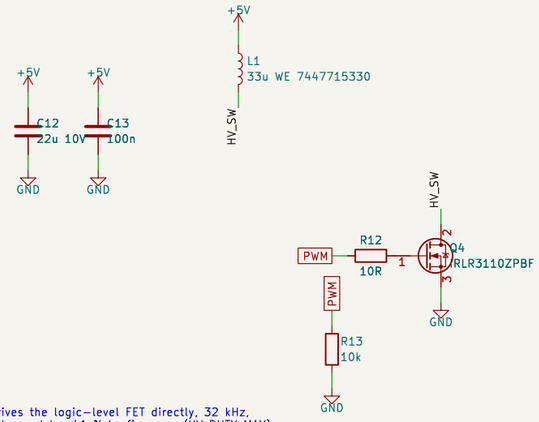
ESP32 rework of TESTA-QUADRA electroNIXclock 3 (PCB-036), USB powered **electroNIX-USB (Z573M)**

Sheet: /ESP32/
File: mcu.kicad_sch

Title: electroNIX-USB – ESP32-WROOM-32E and peripherals

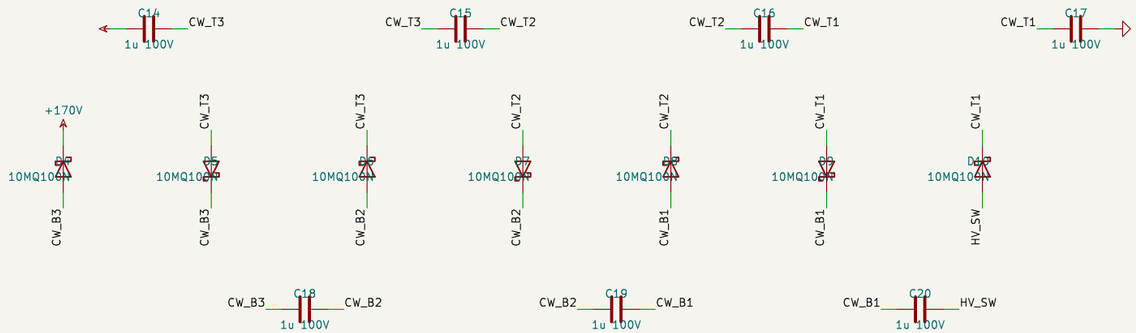
Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-15	**Rev: 0.1**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 3/5

Boost switch (as PCB-036)



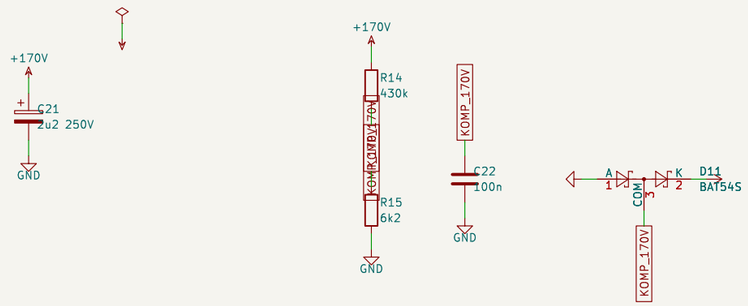
IO2 drives the logic-level FET directly, 32 kHz, duty clamped to ~41 % by firmware (HV_DUTY_MAX). 10k keeps the gate (and IO2) low during boot.

Cockcroft-Walton multiplier, 7 x 10MQ100N, 7 x 1u/100V (as PCB-036)



Each stage adds one boost peak (~45 V at 170 V out); no part sees more than ~100 V.

Output, feedback (KOMP_170V) and ADC clamp



Divider ratio (430k+6k2)/6k2 = 70.35 = HV_DIV_RATIO in display_testa.cpp.
170 V -> 2.42 V at IO35. BAT54S clamps to 3V3 (the original clamped to 5 V).
Use 1 % parts; 430k in 1206 for working voltage.

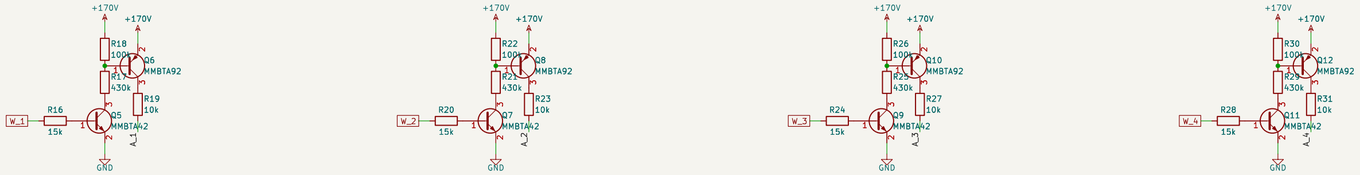
Licensed with the repository; see LICENSE
ESP32 rework of TESTA-QUADRA electroNIXclock 3 (PCB-036), USB powered
electroNIX-USB (Z573M)

Sheet: /HV supply/
File: hv_supply.kicad_sch

Title: electroNIX-USB – 170 V supply (boost + multiplier)

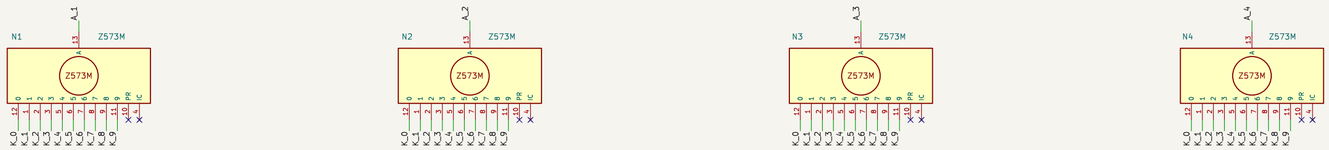
Size: A3	Date: 2026-10-15	**Rev: 0.1**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 4/5

Anode switches (one per tube, MMBTA42 level shift + MMBTA92 high side)



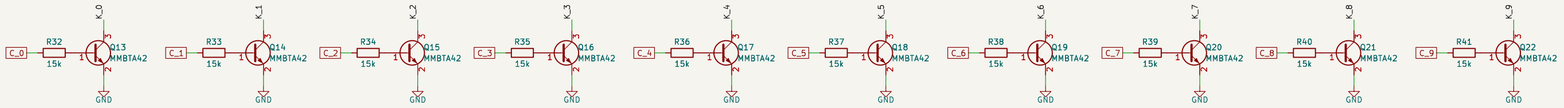
W_n high -> tube n anode at +170V through 10k. Anode current ~2 mA peak.

Tubes (RFT Z573M, B13D base, pin 7 at front)

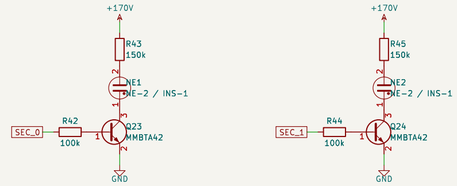


Pin 4 = internal connection (leave open). Pin 10 = PR sign (unused).
Pinout from tube-tester.com Z573M page; check against a real tube before layout.

Cathode switches (MMBTA42, shared by all tubes)



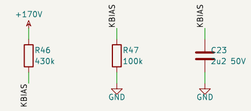
Colon neons (SEC_0 upper / SEC_1 lower)



Original Z573M kit fits one neon (SEC_0). Fit the second for a two-dot colon; firmware drives them independently. 150k: ~0.6 mA at 170 V.

Off-cathode clamp (anti-ghosting, as PCB-036)





KBIAS = 170 V x 100k/530k = ~32 V. Off cathodes are held at or below it, so the lit anode cannot glow them and the MMBTA42s stay well under VCEO.

Licensed with the repository: see LICENSE

ESP32 rework of TESTA-QUADRA electroNIXclock 3 (PCB-036), USB powered
electroNIX-USB (Z573M)

Sheet: /Display/
File: display.kicad_sch

Title: electroNIX-USB – 4 x Z573M, multiplexed

Size: A2	Date: 2026-10-15	**Rev: 0.1**
KiCad E.D.A. kicad-cli 7.0.11+dfsg-1build4		Id: 5/5